

Sara AHARON

Territorial Planning Student – GIS ✦ Remote Sensing ✦ Environmental Research

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PROFILE

Territorial Planning student specializing in GIS-based spatial analysis and remote sensing applications. Experienced with QGIS, Google Earth Engine, Sentinel-2 and Landsat imagery, and geospatial datasets for monitoring urban expansion, vegetation dynamics, and coastal change. Research experience includes multi-temporal environmental analysis and GIS modeling, supported by NASA and ESRI training.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Geography and Geology | Alexandru Ioan Cuza University of Iași

Oct 2024 – Present • Iași, Romania

- ✦ Specialization in Territorial Planning
- ✦ Recipient of Merit Scholarship for academic excellence, 2024–2025 and 2025–2026
- ✦ 1st Prize – Top First-Year Student in Territorial Planning specialization, 2024/2025

Erasmus+ Blended Intensive Programme - Safe mountain explorer

June 2026 • Wrocław, Poland • Wrocław University of Health and Sport Sciences

- ✦ Participated in a BIP focused on mountain safety, outdoor navigation, and wilderness skills
- ✦ Completed workshops in map reading, terrain navigation, and orienteering, alongside practical field sessions including a mountain hiking trip to Śnieżnik and kayaking
- ✦ Developed technical competencies in indoor climbing and outdoor risk assessment within a multinational student cohort

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Operations Manager | Dead Freddie's Restaurant & Bar

Apr 2014 – Jan 2024 • Ocean City, Maryland, USA

- ✦ Directed daily operations and led a multinational team at a high-volume hospitality venue for 10 years, building strong leadership and problem-solving skills

RESEARCH

Cloud-Based Monitoring of Twenty Years of Shoreline Change on Ko Phi Phi Don, Thailand

Jun 2026 • Bucharest, Romania

- ✦ Conducted multi-temporal shoreline change analysis on Ko Phi Phi Don, Thailand (2004–2024) using Landsat and Sentinel-2 imagery processed in Google Earth Engine, QGIS and ArcGIS
- ✦ Applied NDWI-based classification to quantify coastal dynamics, identifying over 1 km² of net shoreline retreat across a 20-year period
- ✦ Integrated remote sensing outputs with GIS-based transect analysis to assess spatial patterns of erosion and accretion across key coastal sectors
- ✦ Examined the intersection of coastal geomorphology and tourism pressure in a high-footfall island destination, with implications for sustainable coastal management

Spatio-Temporal Dynamics of Urban Green Infrastructure - Focșani Municipality (1990–2025)

Nov 2025 • Iași, Romania • 2nd Place, Mihai David National Student Symposium (CERNESIM, UAIC)

- ✦ Conducted a 35-year multi-temporal geospatial analysis of urban expansion patterns and green infrastructure loss across Focșani Municipality
- ✦ Processed and analyzed satellite imagery (Sentinel-2, Landsat 8/9, Copernicus, GHS-POP) in Google Earth Engine, QGIS, and ArcGIS Pro to derive NDVI, NDBI, LST, and Population Density indicators
- ✦ Findings revealed a measurable inverse relationship between built-up density and urban green cover over the study period, with implications for sustainable urban planning policy
- ✦ Presented research at national symposium level, receiving 2nd place recognition

✦ Also presented at: geo-spatial.org Seminars Ed. 45 (Chișinău, Moldova, Mar 2026) • Simpozionul Internațional de SIG și Teledetecție (UAIC, Mar 2026) • Simpozionul Național al Studenților Geografi, Ed. XXXII (Bucharest, Mar 2026) • Conferința Națională "George Vâlsan" (UBB Cluj, May 2026) • Sesiunea Anuală de Comunicări Științifice (Univ. Craiova, May 2026)

CONFERENCES & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- ✧ Participant, JUST4MPA Hands-on Conference Blue Justice and Social Equity for Marine Protected Areas, University of Bucharest, Romania, 8-9 Jun 2026
- ✧ Participant, Hyperspectral Remote Sensing Workshop, organized in collaboration with the Italian, German, and Romanian space agencies, National University of Science and Technology POLITEHNICA Bucharest, Romania, 28 Apr 2026
- ✧ Participant, Climate Change Summit 2025, Palace of Parliament, Bucharest, Romania, 21 Oct 2025

PROJECTS

Just and Resilient Communities - International Field Research

May 2026 • Piatra Neamț, Romania • Van Hall Larenstein University, NL / ADR Nord-Est / UAIC

- ✧ Provided English–Romanian consecutive interpretation and cultural mediation throughout an international research project, enabling effective collaboration across academic and institutional stakeholders
- ✧ Contributed to field research on community livelihoods in Alexandru cel Bun, supporting the development of actionable recommendations for local authorities

CIVIC ENGAGEMENT & LEADERSHIP

Student Policy Delegate - Forum of Romanian Students Worldwide

Sept 2025 • Bucharest, Romania • Ministry of Labour, Family, Youth and Social Solidarity (GOV)

- ✧ Collaborated with student delegates from across Romania and the diaspora to develop consensus-based youth policy recommendations for formal ministerial consideration
- ✧ Drafted, negotiated, and defended policy proposals in a simulated ministerial and parliamentary setting before public officials and policy stakeholders
- ✧ Contributed to debates on youth mental health, addiction recovery support, social inclusion, and public policy development
- ✧ Worked in multidisciplinary teams under time constraints, strengthening negotiation, public speaking, and policy analysis skills

V.O.T.C.A. – Vreau o Țară ca Afară

Sept 2025 • Vatra Dornei, Romania • Ministry of Labour, Family, Youth and Social Solidarity (GOV)

- ✧ Co-contributed to a documentary film (Vreau O Țară Ca Afară, 2025) capturing environmental findings and community impact from field operations across mountain areas of Romania
- ✧ Participated in a national sustainability and civic engagement program focused on environmental protection
- ✧ Conducted mountain area cleanup operations and documented local environmental conditions through field research and visual storytelling

Youth Mentor & Cultural Guide

Aug 2024 • Tulnici, Vrancea, Romania • Department for Romanians Everywhere (GOV)

- ✧ Guided and mentored 50 young members of the Romanian diaspora from Ukraine and the Republic of Moldova during a one-week cultural exchange program, supporting their reconnection with Romanian language, heritage, and identity

DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS AND WEB PROJECTS

- ✧ Manage social media accounts for an independent visual artist, creating promotional content, designing posts, and maintaining audience engagement
- ✧ Manage a personal science and photography Instagram account reaching approximately 10,000 organic monthly views
- ✧ Designed and maintained websites using WordPress, HTML, and CSS, including an artist portfolio website and a personal portfolio hosted on GitHub Pages
- ✧ Create visual content using Canva and Adobe Photoshop for websites, social media, and promotional materials
- ✧ Experienced in photography, visual storytelling, branding, and graphic design, with a strong eye for composition, aesthetics, and audience engagement

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Technical: GIS (QGIS, ArcGIS, Google Earth Engine) ✧ Remote Sensing (Landsat, Sentinel-2, Copernicus, NDVI, NDWI, NDBI, LST) ✧ Data Analysis ✧ Programming (SQL, Python) ✧ Web Development (HTML, CSS, WordPress, GitHub Pages) ✧ Digital Communications (Adobe Photoshop, Canva, Video Editing, Social Media Management)

Soft Skills: Research ✧ Analysis ✧ Problem Solving ✧ Attention to Detail ✧ Leadership ✧ Teamwork ✧ Time Management

Languages: Romanian (native) ✧ English (fluent) ✧ Spanish (intermediate) ✧ German (beginner)

CERTIFICATIONS

GIS, Remote Sensing & Cartography

- ✧ GIS for Climate Action – ESRI (Mar 2026)
- ✧ Going Places with Spatial Analysis – ESRI (Feb 2026)
- ✧ GIS Basics – ESRI (Feb 2026)
- ✧ The ArcGIS Imagery MOOC: Foundations and Frontiers – ESRI (Nov 2025)
- ✧ Fundamentals of Remote Sensing – NASA (Nov 2025)
- ✧ Cartography – ESRI (Oct 2025)
- ✧ Make an Impact with Modern Geo Apps – ESRI (May 2025)

Climate, Conservation & Nature

- ✧ Synthetic Biology in relation to Nature Conservation – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Introduction to Mapping Biodiversity Priorities – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Introduction to Finance for Nature – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Introduction to Conservation and Agriculture – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Introduction to Cities and Nature – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Introduction to Conservation and Climate Change – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ United for Nature and Society – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Nature's Crown Jewels: An Introduction to Nature World Heritage – IUCN-Academy (Aug 2026)
- ✧ Community Forestry 101 – RECOFTC (July 2026)
- ✧ Circular Economy – HP Foundation (May 2025)

Data, AI & Open Science

- ✧ The Rise of GeoAI – Esri on AWS – AWS (Feb 2026)
- ✧ NASA Open Science 101 – NASA (Feb 2026)
- ✧ NASA Open Science Essentials – NASA (Feb 2026)
- ✧ Fundamentals of Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence – AWS (Jan 2026)
- ✧ Intro to Generative AI – Google Cloud Training Online (Jan 2026)
- ✧ Data Science & Analytics – HP Foundation (May 2025)

Other

- ✧ A1/A3 Open Sub Category Drone Pilot – EASA (valid to Dec 2030)
- ✧ ECDL Romania - ICDL Certification (Jan 2010)